

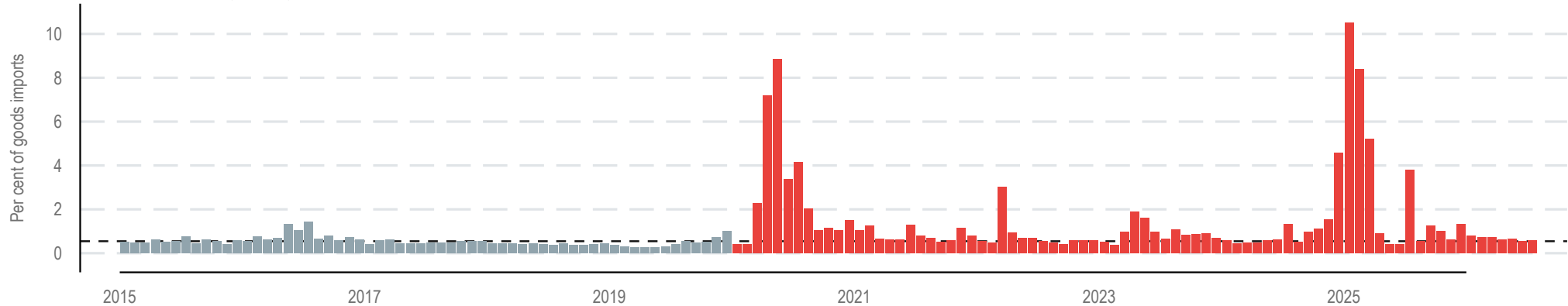
A fixed-weight index cannot see a component whose share moved twentyfold

Gold is in the import price index, but at roughly its base-period weight.

Its actual share of US goods imports reached 10.5% in January 2025. Reweighting it at the share it actually had adds 2.4 points to import price inflation since 2020

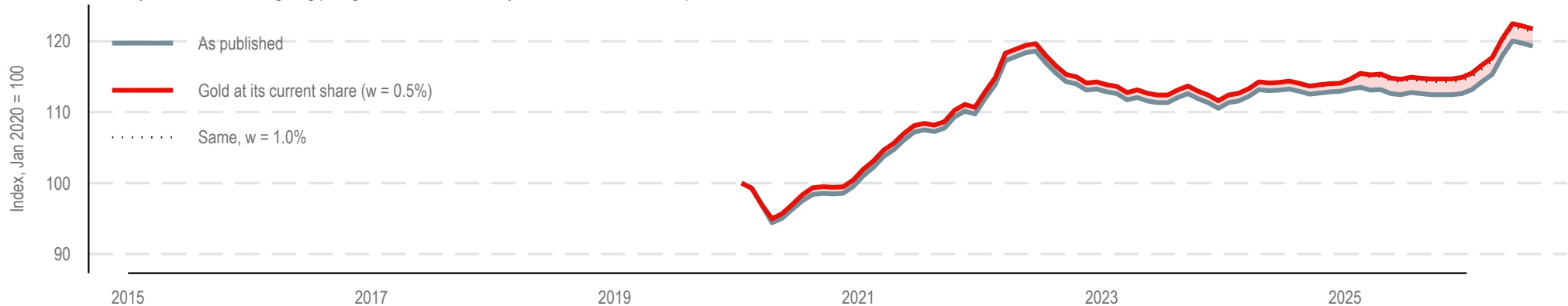
Gold's share of US goods imports

Per cent of the monthly total, by value. The dashed line is the 2015-19 mean, 0.55%



The import price index, as published and reweighted for gold

January 2020 = 100. Reweighting puts gold at its actual monthly share instead of its base-period one



The correction is the standard index-number term $(s_t - w_{base}) \times (\text{gold inflation} - \text{non-gold inflation})$, with non-gold inflation backed out of the published index given w_{base} . BLS does not publish the gold weight, so two values bracketing its pre-2020 trade share are shown. This does NOT affect published GDP: BEA removes nonmonetary gold from the national accounts, so they are not deflated through this index. It affects real trade series built from the trade release, and nowcasts bridging from them